STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-8300
SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 04/01/08	DATE REVISED **03/27/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
	APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: RAPID DEPLOYMENT FORCE	RESOURCES		
SUBJECT RDF OPERATIONS AND TRAINING	CROSS REFERENCE		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for Rapid Deployment operations during deployments and training.

II. Policy:

The Rapid Deployment Force (RDF) is designed to act in conjunction with other Sheriff's Office personnel and specialty units and other Omaha Metro-Area law enforcement agencies during civil disturbances. The RDF shall function under all policies and procedures established for the Sheriff's Office including all appropriate use of force policies. The operations of the RDF, including training, shall be controlled by policy and procedure, and closely supervised by the RDF Commander.

III. Procedure:

A. Training: Deputies assigned to the RDF shall receive appropriate specialized training on an annual basis. The training program shall be developed by the RDF Commander.

1. The RDF Commander or designee may schedule additional periodic training for RDF members. All RDF members are required to attend training. If a member is unable to attend training, the RDF Commander must be notified prior to the training date and provided the reason the member will be unable to attend training.

2. The RDF Commander or designee shall document each training exercise with a synopsis of the training presented and a list of all attending members. The documentation shall be maintained by the RDF Commander and shall be forwarded to the Training Sergeant.

3. All personal and unit equipment shall be inspected and inventoried. This inspection shall occur at least annually. The RDF Commander or designee shall maintain a unit equipment inventory.

B. **Pre-Planning:** In cases where advanced notice of a large gathering of people is available, the RDF commander~~s~~ or designee shall complete the following:

1. Information Gathering: The RDF commanders shall attempt to obtain the following information:

a) The group(s) involved in the event.
b) The nature of event (e.g., complaint/concern of the demonstrating group(s)).
c) The planned actions of the group(s).
d) Schedule of events.
e) Exact time and location of event.
f) Intelligence and background information on involved group(s).
g) Information on past events involving the group(s).
h) Identities and descriptions of group leaders including background information.
i) Identities of potential opposing groups including background information.
j) Photographs, sketches, and/or floor plans of location.
k) Drone use.

2. Meeting: The RDF commanders should attempt to meet with the individual(s) planning the event. The RDF commanders should provide the following information:

a) All pertinent laws regarding the event and potential violations.
b) The position and policy of the Sheriff's Office regarding the event.
c) The recognition of the group's right to protest or demonstrate balanced by the need to respect the rights of the community.

3. Planning: After gathering all relevant information, the RDF commanders shall complete the following:

a) Determine the need for RDF response. If RDF is required, determine the personnel and equipment requirements and the potential requirement for additional agency involvement.

b) Notify all required personnel as far in advance as possible.

c) Inspect all required equipment to ensure availability and functionality.

d) **Meet with County Attorney's Office regarding applicable legal issues.**

e) Create a written Incident Action Plan.

4. Incident Action Plan: The RDF commander~~s~~ or designee shall create a detailed operational plan including:

a) Briefing materials including briefing location and time.
b) Individual assignments and responsibilities.
c) A diagram of the location including RDF member positions.
d) Vehicular and pedestrian traffic control plans.
e) Specific timeline of events.
f) Communication plans.
g) Arrest and use of force guidelines.
h) List of additional resources (highway department, fire, and rescue services, etc.).

C. **Operations:** During deployments, the RDF Commander shall oversee and direct the unit.

1. Any time the RDF is deployed, the Sheriff, Chief Deputy and ADC shall be notified by the RDF Commander/Supervisor.

2. When deployed for an incident, at least one RDF member shall respond to the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office to gather all unit equipment.

3. The RDF Commander shall have the authority to request Metro Rapid Deployment Unit be activated to respond to any incident in place of or in addition to the RDF. The RDF Commander shall notify the Sheriff and ADC if another agency is utilized.

4. Briefing: When possible, the RDF shall meet for a briefing prior to deployment. During the briefing the following information shall be provided:

a) The operational plan shall be covered.
b) Directions for arrest and use of force shall be covered.
c) Team leaders shall be provided a copy of the operational plan and their specific assignments.
d) The position of the Sheriff's Office regarding tolerance of given behaviors or parameters for acceptable conduct shall be covered.
e) The present status of the incident shall be covered.

5. Deployment of Personnel: The RDF Commander shall determine the appropriate deployment of personnel during a potential civil disturbance.

a) Show of Force Approach: The majority of personnel are deployed directly to the scene. The RDF members form a line separating two opposing factions and attempt to prevent violent confrontation.

b) Strength in Reserve Approach: Only a small number of deputies are present at the scene, generally consisting of the Platoon Leader and/or an RDF team leader and a small number of deputies. The remainder of the RDF is staged at a location where its presence is unknown to the event participants but is close enough to afford an expedient deployment should the need arise.

6. Chemical munitions and less lethal munitions may only be deployed with permission from the RDF Commander or the Platoon Leader.

D. **Mass-Arrests:** During protests and civil disturbances arrest decisions must be approved by an RDF squad/platoon leader or the RDF Commander unless an emergency exists.

1. In the event many arrests are anticipated, the on-duty jail supervisor shall be notified.

2. At any time, the court services supervisor shall be notified to assist with transportation of arrestees. The Court Services Supervisor shall contact additional non-RDF personnel to assist with transportation of arrestees. For custodial arrests in excess of twenty (20), the RDF Commander or designee may contact the contracted bus service (see the Jail Emergency Manual/Jail Evacuation).

3. Demonstration Arrests: Prior to arrests for trespassing, the owner/agent of the property on which the incident is occurring shall advise the RDF Commander or their designee that he or she wishes them to leave.

a) The order to leave should be done by law enforcement officials and should be recorded if possible. The request to leave should include specific directions for the parties to disperse, specific consequences for not leaving (i.e., arrest), and should be repeated a minimum of three times.

b) If possible, two deputies should be positioned at the rear of the crowd to ensure that the order to leave was audible to the entire crowd. The deputies should also record the warning if possible.

c) If due to the level of noise all parties are unable to hear the warning, individual warnings to leave should be issued by a law enforcement officer prior to arrest.

d) Arrest teams shall be organized by the RDF Commander or Platoon Leader.

4. Active Civil Disturbance Arrests: Generally, arrests should be directed by a squad or platoon leader and affected by at least two law enforcement officers designated as an arrest team. Individual law enforcement officers should avoid leaving formation to affect an arrest without direction except during emergency situations.

5. Arrest Processing: Once an individual has been taken into custody by an arrest team, handcuffed and pat searched, he or she shall be taken to the transportation area for processing.

a) One officer on the arrest team shall be designated the arresting officer, and he or she shall be responsible for the completion of the citation, and supplemental report.

b) An arrest packet shall be completed by the arrest team. The packet shall include an Intake Assessment form, an Intake form including property inventory, and a citation.

(1) A sealable bag shall be included to place the arrestee's personal items.

(2) The arresting officer should note any details of the arrest, including specific offense information, in the Officer's notes of the citation.

c) Upon reaching an intake deputy, the citation number shall be written on the back of the Intake Assessment form.

d) The arresting officer shall be responsible for completing a supplemental report for each arrest.

e) The RDF Commander or designee shall complete the original offense report for the incident.

6. At the conclusion of the incident, the RDF Commander/Supervisor shall notify the ADC that the incident/deployment is over. The RDF Commander/Supervisor shall provide the ADC with the details surrounding the incident.